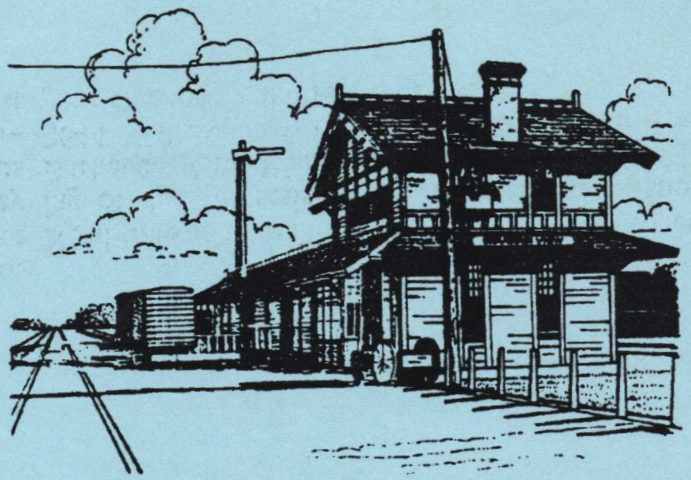
Mountain View Historical Association Newsletter

P.O. Box 252
Mountain View, CA 94042

Hilton U. Brown, III - Editor



Barbecue & Raffle The August Meeting

The August 6, 2000 meeting of the Historical Association will be our ***Seventh Annual Barbecue & Raffle***. The place will be the patio area at the Mountain View Senior Center, 266 Escuela Ave. This is the same location as for the last four years.

The membership was mailed a flyer recently about the ***Barbecue & Raffle.*** The flyer included a form to clip and return, along with your check, to let the Association know how many to plan for and much food to prepare. If you lost the flyer, don't despair! This Newsletter contains on page three all of the necessary information, so clip the form and send it in! Do it! The Association needs to know you're coming!

The necessary business items are discussed elsewhere in this newsletter and they will be brief. There will be a little live music to aid conversation and digestion. Al Jehning will again perform his magic with the hamburgers. There will, of course be the usual fabulous raffle prizes.

The important part of the day is the opportunity to get together with friends and acquaintances for relaxed socializing. Bring your friends. If they are not members, we'll still welcome them. Perhaps they might even be persuaded to join. Anyway, let us know you're coming, and we'll see you at the ***Seventh Annual Barbecue & Raffle*** on Sunday, August 6.

Fire Fighting in The Santa Clara Valley The May Meeting

Leonard W. Williams, CPA of neighboring Sunnyvale, was our speaker at the May meeting. He collects real fire engines, and his talk about them was accompanied by a slide show.

Besides collecting Fire Engines, Mr. Williams is a member of the *Fire Associates of Santa Clara Valley*, an organization that provides canteen services for all Santa Clara County fire departments at fires of extended duration. He thus had personal experience at the major Mountain View Academy fires in the early 1970's and the Minton Lumber Yard fire just a few years ago.

The Mountain View Fire Department supplemented the presentation with a display of both old and new fire fighting equipment. Two Mountain View Fire Fighters stood by to answer questions and explain the equipment. It was a very interesting meeting.

Need Transportation?

Need transportation to the Sunday, August 6, meeting of the Mountain View Historical Association Barbecue? Give Wally Ericksen a call at (650) 948 2644. Wally will try to help in finding a driver from your area who can offer you a ride.

Mancini's Tower
By Candace Bowers

An eye-catching landmark once stood at the gateway to downtown Mountain View. Ugo Mancini's Chrysler dealership, with its 52-foot tower, occupied the corner of El Camino and Castro Street. The Mancini Motors tower is still instantly recognizable in old street scenes of the 1940s, 50s, and 60s.

A native of Italy, Mancini had been in this country 10 years when he opened a Nash dealership in Mountain View in 1921. In 1933, he changed to selling Chryslers. Coincidentally, the Chrysler Corporation was staging an exhibit at the 1939 World's Fair at Treasure Island. By that time, Mancini was ready to build new business offices at a different location, and arranged to buy the materials of the former Chrysler exhibit. He paid $3000 for the entire exhibit, then sold some unwanted material for that same purchase price. That money was used to buy the land at the corner of El Camino and Castro Street (the current site of Home Savings.) To further recoup his expenses, Mancini was able to sell part of his plot of land to another company, for use as a service station.

The main expense was therefor the transportation of the remains of the Chrysler exhibit from Treasure Island, across the Bay Bridge to Mountain View. The move cost Mancini about $2000. The stainless steel tower weighed in at 20 tons and literally stopped traffic as it traveled across the bridge in the middle of the night. The tower, topped by a globe that was 9 feet in diameter, was a Mountain View landmark from 1940 until the early 1970s. Mancini relocated his business to Sunnyvale in April of 1971, leaving behind the tower that featured his name running vertically down its length. The site was eventually sold to Home Savings in 1974, and subsequently demolished.

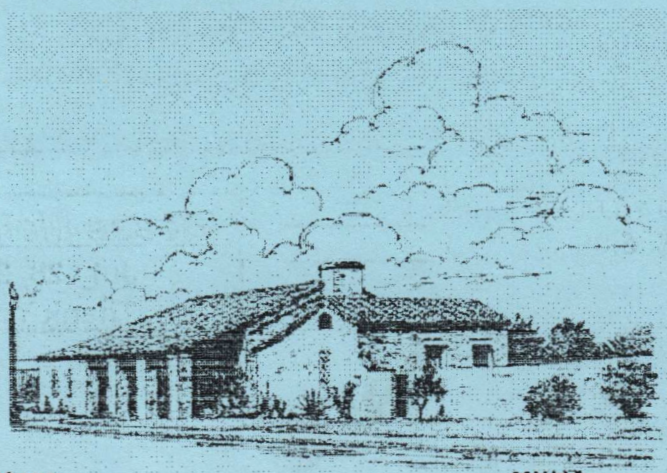
Executive Committee Meeting

The Executive Committee of the Mountain View Historical Association met June 29, 2000. The Membership Report is given in detail elsewhere in this Newsletter. The Treasurer's Report is likewise presented elsewhere.

The Association has received 2 pictures and 2 chairs from the Stierlin Estate. These are in addition to the Armoire received previously. These are valuable items, and a safe display space is becoming a matter of concern. The City Manager will be approached to discuss this matter.

We are entering discussions with the DeAnza Historical Center over publication of the History of Mountain View. The Ways and Means Chair will look into getting professional help for funding our publishing venture.

The Seventh Annual Barbecue and Raffle will be held August 6. Vice President John Viscovich was appointed to oversee physical arrangements. Mario & Liz Ambra, Matt Pear, John Figueroa and Hilton Brown will all assist with setup. Raffle tickets will sell for 6 for $5.00, and the meal price will be $10.00. The committee will call their phone list by July 23 to encourage members to come to the Barbecue.



SAVE THE ADOBE

Mountain View Historical Association
Barbecue & Raffle
Sunday, August 6, 2000
1:00 P.M.
Senior Center
266 Escuela Ave.
Mtn. View, CA 94042

Menu:

Zesty Hamburgers
Condiments
Garden Fresh Green Salad
Delicious Potato Salad
Baked Beans
Apple Pie - A La Mode

Cost:

Adults	$ 10.00 each
Children	$ 5.00 each
Raffle tickets	
6 for	$ 5.00

Agenda:

~~1:00 PM Check in/Social Hour~~
~~2:30 PM Barbecue~~
~~3:25 PM Business~~
~~3:30 PM Raffle~~

Bring your own:

Table Settings
Beverages

Detach Here and Return Form Below

Barbecue Order Form

Send This Form With Your Check to:
MVHA Barbecue
P.O. Box 252
Mtn. View, CA 94042

Your Name and Phone: _____

Names of Guests: _____

Number of Adults ____ @ **$ 10.00 =** **$** _____
Number of Children ____ @ **$ 5.00 =** **$** _____

Total Amount Enclosed **$** _____

Please Mail By:
July 28, 2000
Thank You

Old Newspaper Items Compiled By Barbara Kinchen

125 Years Ago (1875): After four days of oral and written examinations, the public school closed for the summer. A program of spelling matches, musical numbers and recitations took place on the last afternoon.

Population of Santa Clara County is estimated to be 31,000 with 8,997 registered voters.

"The Fourth of July was honored in a very appropriate manner. S.P. Taylor made the valley ring with the sound of the old mountain cannon, which, for the last twenty years has been used on the occasion of waking up the citizens of Mountain View."

Threshing is over and more than 40,000 sacks of wheat and barley are now stored in the railroad company warehouse at Mountain View Station.

Mountain View is in "receipt of a butcher shop, a harness shop, and Chinese wash house, within the past two weeks."

100 Years Ago (1900): Pierre Klein, Montebello district vineyardist and winemaker, received a gold medal for his exhibit of wines at the Paris Exposition. (On display at the Mountain View History Center.)

The brickyard was supplying bricks for the new buildings at Stanford University as it had done for the original buildings. Only a quarter of a mile from the train station, the yard's brick clay is said to be the finest in California.

An explosion in a shed at the rear of the Weilheimer General Store destroyed the shed, a barn and many windows in nearby structures. A hole had been punched in a 25-pound can of blasting powder, a fuse inserted and lit. Much of the downtown could have been destroyed if other powder, dynamite, gasoline and coal oil in the shed had caught fire or exploded. A young feeble-minded teen-ager was immediately suspected and confessed. Sometime in the past the store had refused him credit.

The Bank of Mountain View opened for business on September 12, in its brick mission-style building on Castro Street. (This was the first bank in the town. Railway Express later occupied the Building.)

75 Years Ago (1925): Glen Theatre showed "The Lighthouse By The Sea" staring Rin Tin Tin, the wonder dog.

State Highway Garage, Renaldi and Mancini proprietors, has outgrown its building. Ugo Mancini has purchased property at El Camino and Ehrhorn Avenue where he will have a showroom built for Nash auto sales, while Mr. Renaldi will remain at the present location.

Miss Martha Job, who has been on furlough from her position with the Y.W.C.A. in China, was honored at a reception at the Baptist Church.

Property owners have petitioned for a road to run from the Bubb and Glen pumping plants on Grant Road to the highway opposite Calderon Avenue. This would shorten the distance into town for residents along Grant Road.

During July and August the Baptist, Methodist, Adventist and Presbyterian Churches were holding union services on Sunday evenings.

Anway Undertaking Company has purchased the office and residence property of Dr. A.H. MacFarlane, at 340 Castro, and will transform it into a mortuary. Some residents protested, but as the area was already designated a business district Mr. Anway received a permit.

Olin W. Tait was issued a season ticket to the new Kingsport Plunge for his winning slogan to be used in advertising - "The King Sport at Kingsport." (Does anyone have pictures of this salt water plunge at the end Whisman Road?)

Mrs Gonzales of Santa Clara had her hair bobbed. Her husband objected and threw her out of their house and sued for a divorce. The judge granted it, ruling that a "woman past middle age should not bob her hair without her husband's consent."

Six new houses are under construction and nine families are already living on Loreto Street, in the new Palmita Park subdivision.

50 Years Ago (1950): Service station operators expected the price of gasoline to go up two cents a gallon. At present, ethyl costs 26¢ a gallon and regular sells for 24¢

Headlines told of North Korean troops crossing the 38th parallel toward Seoul.

Jim Thomas, Superintendent of Public Works, was given a new title of City Administrator. He will still have the same responsibilities - all public works departments, personnel administration and most fiscal matters.

The local Greyhound bus depot, at 216 Castro for twenty years, has opened up the street at 374 Castro. According to manager John Parmelee, over 600 passengers a day go through this station.

Receiving prizes at the State Fair were Frank Takamoto for chrysanthemums and Mountain View Greenhouse, on Bailey Avenue, for carnations. County Floral winners were Leonard Oku, Yoshio Mishimoto and G. Imamura. Mrs. Jeannie Julian Holtzclaw won recognition for her zinnias.

Young Adventist men were urged to sign up for a Cadet Medical Corps Training course at Mountain View Academy. A new auditorium at the school has been named for Principal C.H. Baker. He is leaving to become head of the Academy at Loma Linda.

Foster's Old Fashion Freeze celebrated its first anniversary in Mountain View on August 4.

Hunt Foods, Inc., estimates that 1200 tons of cucumbers will be processed into pickles this season by the 27 workers employed in the plant in downtown Mountain View.

Kiwanis Club introduced plans for a Scout Center to be built on a three-acre site off Leksich Avenue. Money for land and buildings are to be raised by public subscription. Membership in Mountain View scouts totals over 500 — Cubs, Brownies, Boy Scouts, Girl Scouts, Mariners, Sea and Air Scouts.

August 4, was the date for the grand opening of Monte Vista Drive-in Theatre on Grant Road near El Camino, with the largest screen on the peninsula and spaces for 825 cars.

Street Talk From Barbara Kinchen

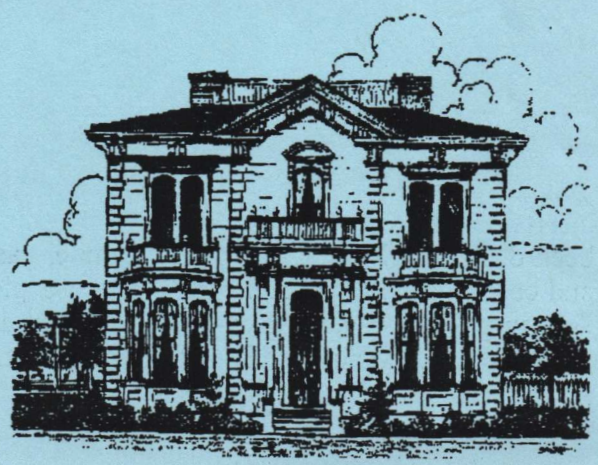
The **May Street Talk Puzzler** was: *For whom was Calderon Avenue named?*

Mercedes Castro, sister of Crisanto Castro, married Andres Calderon in 1856. In 1883 the Castro and Calderon families sold about 120 acres to A.M. Stoddard, who then laid out a road from the railroad tracks to Church Street with five acre lots on each side. At first the road was called Stoddard, but by 1886 it was Calderon Avenue and said to have been as smooth and level as a race track.

And this leads to the **November Street Talk Puzzler** — To the west of town there was also a Calderon Road. This caused much confusion until 1948 when the Board of Supervisors approved a name change. What was the name selected?

MVUHS Alumni Day

Saturday, October 7, 2000 is Mountain View Union High School "Eagle" Yearly Alumni Day. The place is Cuesta Park, and the time is 9:00 a.m. until Sundown. There will be music and dancing and a raffle. Eagle T-Shirts and Caps will be on sale. Bring your own tables and chairs. There will be food vendors available. Ex-Awalt and MVHS Alumni welcome. A time to socialize, have fun and reminisce. Call Ann, (650) 964-3550, Barbara (650) 969-2262 or John (650) 967-3790 for further information.



Historical Resources in Santa Clara County

Listed below are a few of the historic resources of Santa Clara County.

Museum of American Heritage — Electrical and Mechanical devices in use between 1800 and 1950. Located in the Williams House and Gardens, 351 Homer St., Palo Alto, CA 94306.

Los Altos History House — Depression era orchardist's home. Located in the J. Gilbert Smith House, 51 S. San Antonio Rd., Los Altos, CA 94022.

Rengstorff House — Italianate farmhouse built in 1867. Located at 3070 N. Shoreline Blvd., Mountain View, CA 94043.

Moffett Field Historical Museum — Located in the awe-inspiring "Hangar One" at Moffett Field.

Sunnyvale Historical Museum — Located at Murphy Park, N. Sunnyvale Ave at California Ave., Sunnyvale.

Iron Man Museum — Located at the former Joshua Hendy Iron Works, 401 E. Hendy Ave., Sunnyvale.

South Bay Historical Railroad Museum — Located in the restored Santa Clara Train Depot, 1005 Railroad Ave., Santa Clara, CA 95050.

Peralta Adobe & Fallon House Historic Site — Unique look into early San Jose. Adobe dates from 1797. Fallon House dates from 1855 and is fully restored and lavishly furnished. 175 W. St. John St., San Jose, CA 95110.

For more information on these and other sites, contact the *Heritage Council of Santa Clara County, PO Box 26767, San Jose, CA 95159.* Phone (408)236 2274 — hcscc@accesscom.com

Treasurer's Notes

The Association's financial condition improved slightly over the previous quarter. Income exceeded Expense by $156.49, but Fund Balances increased $126.00. The Unencumbered Balance has therefor improved slightly to - ($ 62.56). Third Quarter Income, which will include the net from both the Seventh Annual Barbecue and Participation in the Small Brewer's Festival should substantially exceed expenses.

The Association invests its surplus funds in Certificates of Deposit. It is Association practice to purchase 180 day CD's, buying one each month so that the maturities will provide a reliable source of funds as needed. As of June30, 2000, the funds of the Association were distributed as follows:

Checking Account 3.71%		$ 7,180.56
CD #1 5.30% Matures	9/30/00	2,500.00
CD #2 5.35%	11/19/00	2,500.00
CD #3 5.40%	12/20/00	2,500.00
Total		$14,680.56

Interest on the CD's will be credited at maturity.

Required Business

In November of even numbered years the Association elects a new slate of officers. To accomplish this in a orderly manner, the Association Bylaws require the election of a Nominating Committee consisting of three members to be chosen at the August meeting. The slate selected by the Nominating Committee will be presented in the November, 2000 Newsletter. Nominations from the floor will be accepted at the time of the election, at the November, 2000 Annual meeting.

The MVHA Bylaws also require the membership to elect a three member Auditing Committee at the August meeting. This Committee is required to present a written report at the November annual meeting.

There may be other business to discuss at the Seventh Annual Barbecue, but the business part of the event should be no more than five to ten minutes.